

भारत सरकार (GOVERNMENT OF INDIA)
रेल मंत्रालय (MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS)
रेलवे बोर्ड (RAILWAY BOARD)

No. 2017/CE-IV/LX/Misc./244 (LCs) Pt.

New Delhi, dated 16.07.2025

**Principal Chief Engineers,
All Zonal Railways.**

Sub: Careful examination of GADs & TADs of Bridges, ROBs, RUBs & Railway Flyovers.

Ref: EDCE(G)/RB letter no. 2017/CE-I/CT/13/Procedure simplification dated 20.10.2017 & 22.04.2022 (copy enclosed).

In reference to the above, certain instructions were issued for faster clearance of engineering drawings. A few cases have been reported recently, where GADs have been found approved without ensuring comprehensive planning of approaches with proper gradients, curvature and other essential aspects of geometric design of road as per relevant IRC guidelines.

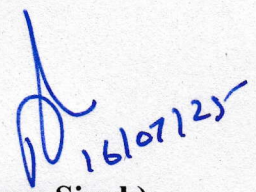
2. In view of above, it is advised that mandatory provisions of relevant codes, IRS guidelines to ensure trouble free execution and safety of road users must be ensured while conducting the scrutiny of GADs.

3. It should be ensured that no execution should start at site unless the GAD with Road owning authorities is jointly approved. Cases of violation by State Governments/Road owning authorities should be raised at higher level. This will help not only in faster approval but will ensure that the public infrastructure being created is safe and as per laid down standards.

4. Joint meetings with Road owning authorities/other executing departments should be held to counsel them and impress upon the need of correct preparations of GADs before submission.

This issues with the approval of PED (Bridge), Railway Board.

DA: As above.


(Anupam Singh)
Executive Director/(B&S)-II
Railway Board

Copy to:-

1. DG/IRICEN, Pune for information.
2. GM(Const.), NFR, CAO/Cs & CAO/C/RSPs all Zonal Railways.
3. PED/Infra-II, RDSO/Lucknow.



भारत सरकार Government Of India
रेल मंत्रालय Ministry Of Railways
(रेलवे बोर्ड) (Railway Board)

No. 2017/CE-I/CT/13/Procedure Simplification

New Delhi, dated 20.10.2017

General Managers
All Indian Railways

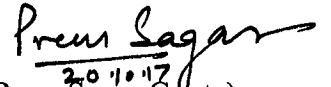
Sub: Approval of Engineering Drawings

Presently, the approval of engineering drawings takes lot of time, which also delay the execution of work. To expedite approval of engineering drawings, Board (ME, CRB) has approved the following:

1. All GADs, except drawings involving construction/ modification of yards, and Bridges (including ROB, RUB, FOB, ROR flyover etc.) shall be approved at the level of division. The structural design & drawing work shall be carried out by open line or construction organisation who is the executing agency for the work.
2. GADs involving construction/modification of yards, where open line is the executing agency, after clearance by all concerned divisional branch officers and DRM, shall be examined by CTPM in HQ and approved by CPDE.
3. GADs involving construction/modification of yards, where construction organisation is the executing agency, after clearance by all concerned divisional branch officers and DRM, shall be examined by CTPM in HQ and approved by CPDE.
4. GADs of Bridges (including ROB, RUB, FOB, ROR flyover etc.), where executing agency is open line, after clearance by concerned divisional branch officers and DRM, shall be approved by CBE in HQ. The structural design & drawing work shall be carried out by bridge branch at HQ level.
5. GADs of all **minor, major and important railway bridges** which shall affect the existing railway bridges, and GADs of ROB/RUB/FOB/ROR flyover etc., where executing agency is construction organisation, after clearance from concerned divisional branch officers and DRM, shall be approved by CBE in HQ. However, the complete structural design & drawing work shall be carried out by Construction organisation.
6. GADs of all **minor, major and important railway bridges** which do not affect the existing railway bridges, where executing agency is construction organisation, shall be approved by concerned CE/Construction. The complete structural design & drawing work shall also be carried out by Construction organisation.

Prem Sagar
20.10.17

7. ADRM/Tech. shall be responsible to ensure that GADs are approved/ cleared by all concerned branch officers in division within a period not exceeding 15 days. ADRM/Tech. shall get GADs signed at Divisional level in a meeting to be conducted for this purpose, instead of file shuffling among divisional officers.
8. Similarly, AGM shall be responsible in HQ. to ensure that GADs are approved/cleared by concerned HOD within a period not exceeding 7 days. AGM shall personally ensure adherence of time limit by CTPM, CPDE & CBE (for bridge GADs). There shall be no other signatures on the GADs in the HQ.
9. This is issued in supersession of all previous instructions on the subject. The necessary correction slips to manuals shall be issued in due course of time.



(Prem Sagar Gupta)

Executive Director/ Civil Engineering(G)/Railway board
[Phone : 011-23383379, e-mail address: edceg@rb.railnet.gov.in]

Copy forwarded for information to :

- (i) PCEs, All Indian Railways;
- (ii) CAOs(Con), All Indian Railways



भारत सरकार Government of India
रेल मंत्रालय Ministry of Railways
(रेलवे बोर्ड Railway Board)



No.2017/CE-I/CT/13/ProcedureSimplification

New Delhi, dated 22.04.2022

The General Managers,
All Indian Railways

Sub.: Standard Procedure Order for ESP, SIP & GAD approval in Zonal Railway

Railway Board vide letter No. 2017/CE-I/CT/13/ procedure simplification dated 20.10.2017 has circulated procedure Order to expedite approval of drawings.

In addition to above, following detail Procedure Order to expedite approval of ESP, SIP & GAD:

1. Approval of ESP:

- i. ESP should be signed by JAG officers of Originating Department, DRM of Division and HQ officers (CE/Con, CEE/Con, CSTE/Plg, CSTE/Con, CTPM & CE/Planning For ESPs of Construction Organisation & CTPM, CSTE/Plg & CE/Planning for ESPs of Open Line/RVNL/RITES/IRCON/Other Units). ESP signed by JAG/SG/Equivalent officers of Originating Department should be circulated by concerned JAG/SG/Equivalent officer to divisional branch officers (Sr DOM, Sr DEN, Sr DEN Co, Sr DSTE, Sr DCM & Sr DEE TRD) and ADRM. DRM/ADRM should resolve conflicting observations, if any in consultation with Originating Department and ESP should be cleared within 15 days from Division.
- ii. ESP should be prepared as per the concept plans given in the DPRs in the normal course unless the extra facilities which are minor in nature are approved by DRM and major modifications/additions are approved by GM.
- iii. While finalizing Concept Plan during DPR/DE, standard layout & instructions issued vide Railway Board's letter No 2017/CE-I/CT/13/Procedure simplification, dated 20.10.2017 & 2015/Sig/WG/Standardise layout, dated 12.07.2017, may be followed.
- iv. Concept plan for remodeling of yard included in the DPR should be revalidated by CTPM, CE Planning, CSTE/Planning & concerned SAG Officers of Originating Department before initiation of approval of ESP to avoid changes in ESP at approval stage and written minutes to be issued.
- v. Revision of ESP should be divided into following two broad categories:
 - a. **Major Revision:** resulting into changes of yard layout. Provision of additional line, additional cross over, addition/deletion of slip/catch siding etc. shall qualify for major yard remodeling. ESP once approved should not be taken up for major revision without approval of General Manager. If revision of ESP is inescapable due to any reason, the onus taking the approval of GM within 15 days shall lie with the Department asking for revision of the ESP. Phasing of work to be indicated department wise.
 - b. **Minor Revision:** This does not result in change of layout of the yard but is required to rectify the minor defects or deficiency detected after approval of ESP/at the time of preparation of SIP or due to any other reason. In case of minor alteration in ESP, the approval of ESP should be only by Concerned JAG/SG & SAG Officers of Originating Department & CSTE/Planning. Change of turnout from 1 in 12 to 1 in 8 ½ or vice versa, classification of line, change in location of gradient post, change in chainage, closure of LC gate, Change in classification of LC gates & updation to match actuals at site shall be treated as minor alteration.

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- c. Categorization of Planning/alteration into minor or major apart from above defined categories may be done Jointly by CE planning and CSTE Planning or CSTE Project.

In case of any difference of opinion regarding categorization of alteration into minor and major, decision of AGM shall be final.

2. **Sanction or grade condonation:** Proposal for grade condonation is based on approved ESP and infringement table in the approved ESP should be made. Once ESP alongwith infringement table is approved, there is no need to involve Divisional officers in approval of grade condonation proposal. Grade condonation proposal signed by the concerned JAG/SG & SAG officers of Originating Department should be submitted to CE Planning for further processing for approval and signature of concerned PHODs (PCOM, PCSTE, PCEE and PCE) and GM and submission to CRS for sanction.
3. **Approval of project sheet** - Project sheet shall continue to be approved by Planning Cell of HQ. Planning Cell should broadly check the project sheet for violation of Terms of References to the project, if any. Executing agency should furnish the certificate that level of bridges as shown in approved GAD has been adopted in Project Sheet. Any discrepancy in the levels shown in ESP, GAD of projects and Project sheet shall be reconciled by Executing Agency and will be rectified in completion drawing.
4. Approval of ESP should not be linked with the approval of the project sheet.
5. Checklist for approval of ESP, GAD of major and Minor bridges, project sheet and other drawings should be signed by JAG/SG officer of the concerned Department.
6. ADRM/Infra (or nominated ADRM) shall ensure that GADs are approved/cleared by all concerned branch officers in division within a period not exceeding 15 days. ADRM/Infra shall get GADs signed at Divisional level in a meeting to be conducted for this purpose, instead of file shuffling among divisional officers.
7. Similarly, AGM shall monitor in HQ to ensure that GADs are approved/cleared by concerned HOD within a period not exceeding 7 days and time limit is adhered by CTPM, CE Planning & CBE (for bridge GADs). There shall be no other signatures on the GADs in the HQ.
8. Timelines in working days for comments / approval shall be as under:

	DRM and Divisional Officers	CAO/C	CTPM	CSTE/Plg or CSTE(Proj.) or CSTE(Con)	CE(P&D)/CBE	Total
ESPs						
Upto 5 lines	15	7	3	3 (Parallel)	7	32
More than 5 lines & major junction	18	10	5	5 (Parallel to CTPM)	10	43
GADs						
Minor Bridges	7	7	--	--	7	21
Major Bridges	10	10	--	--	10	30

* The time lines given above are reckoned since submission/re-submission after compliance of the observations/clarifications.

9. **Approval of SIP** - SIP should be approved as per the procedure and timelines mentioned in Railway Board letter No. 2016/Sig./Drg.Off/1 Dtd.09.11.2017.
 - a. Copies of the tentative SIP based on approved Engineering Scale Plan (ESP) will be sent simultaneously to CTPM and nominated ADRM of the concerned Division.
 - b. Nominated ADRM will obtain the comments of Sr.DOM and Sr.DSTE on the tentative SIP and advise the same to CTPM.

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- c. After scrutinising the division's comments, CTPM will send his comments to CSTE(Const.)/CSTE(Proj.).
- d. On receipt of comments from CTPM, necessary modifications will be incorporated in the tentative SIP by CSTE(Const.)/CSTE(Proj.)/CSTE(Plg) and the plan got approved and signed by CTPM. In case of any technical difficulty or difference in opinion in complying with the comments of CTPM, matter will be discussed and decided by CSTE(Const.)/CSTE(Proj.)/CSTE(Plg) in consultation with CTPM.

Timelines in working days for comments / approval shall be as under:

Work	Route	No of Days for Preparation of SIP (From the date of approval of ESP)	Division	CTPM	CSTE (Const.) /CSTE (Proj.)/CSTE(Plg)	Total
Minor 15 days	Up to 50 routes	15	7	3	2	22
	From 50 to 200 routes	28-30	7	4	3	29
Major 30 days	More than 200 routes	40-45	10	7	3	50

- e. The above timetable shall be strictly adhered to, so that delay in execution of signalling works is avoided. SIPs not getting approved as per the timelines given above shall be discussed in the plans meeting conducted by AGM.
- f. At the stage of approving the SIP, no change in already approved ESP should be demanded. However if change in ESP is inescapable, the request for change in ESP should be routed through the PHOD, by the department requesting the change.
10. Based on the above, all Zonal Railways/Other Units should make Detailed Procedure Order to expedite approval of ESP, SIP & GAD.

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22.4.22

(अजीत कुमार झा)

कार्यपालक निदेशक सिविल इंजीनियरिंग(जी)

रेलवे बोर्ड

[Rly No. 030-44803, MTNL No.-011-23383379]

Email address: edceg2022@gmail.com

Copy forwarded for information :

- (i) PCEs, All Indian Railways
- (ii) CAOs(Con.), All Indian Railways
- (iii) CSTE, All Indian Railways